Wildfires and Your Safety

For Everyone
AUG. 24, 2026, VISIT LINK FOR DETAILS.
ESPAÑOL

AT A GLANCE

- Take steps to be ready for a wildfire and prepare your home and landscaping to reduce your risk.
- Learn how to protect yourself and your family from a wildfire, evacuate safely during a wildfire, and how to stay healthy when you return home.

Who is at increased risk



Wildfire smoke can make anyone sick, but some people have a higher risk of getting sick. Wildfire smoke can reach far away from where fires burn. Wildfire smoke can make anyone sick, but some people have a higher risk of getting sick, such as children, people who have chronic conditions, and

people who are pregnant. Be ready to protect yourself against smoke and ash before, during, and after a wildfire.

How Wildfire Smoke Affects Your Body
Wildfire Smoke and Children
Wildfire Smoke and People with Chronic Conditions
Wildfire Smoke and Pregnancy

Prepare for wildfires



Take steps to be ready for a wildfire and prepare your home and landscaping to reduce your risk from a wildfire.

More and more people make their homes in areas that are prone to wildfires. You can take steps to be ready for a wildfire and prepare your home and landscaping to reduce your risk from a wildfire.

KEEP READINGPreparing for Wildfires

Stay safe during a wildfire



Reduce your exposure to wildfire smoke.

It's important for everyone to reduce their exposure to smoke. Wildfire smoke irritates your eyes, nose, throat, and lungs. It can make it hard to breathe and make you cough or wheeze. Children and people with asthma, COPD, heart disease, diabetes, chronic kidney disease, or who are pregnant need to be especially careful about breathing wildfire smoke.

KEEP READINGSafety Guidelines: Wildfires and Wildfire Smoke

Stay safe after a wildfire



Take steps to protect yourself and your loved ones when returning to your home after a fire.

If your home was affected by a wildfire, do not return home until authorities say it is safe. Take steps to protect yourself and your loved ones when returning to your home after a fire.

KEEP READINGSafety Guidelines: After a Wildfire

Resources

- Natural Disasters and Severe Weather
- Fighting Wildfires | NIOSH | CDC
- Be Smoke Ready (airnow.gov)
- Wildfires | Ready.gov
- NFPA - Firewise USA®
- Fire Weather
- Fire and Smoke Map (airnow.gov)
- HeatRisk | Tracking | NCEH | CDC

ON THIS PAGE

Who is at increased risk

Prepare for wildfires

Stay safe during a wildfire

Stay safe after a wildfire

Resources

RELATED PAGES

Wildfire Smoke

Preparing for Wildfires

Wildfire Smoke

Preparing for Wildfires

For Everyone
AUG. 24, 2026, VISIT LINK FOR DETAILS.
ESPAÑOL

KEY POINTS

- More and more people make their homes in areas that are prone to wildfires.
- You can take steps to be ready for a wildfire and to prepare your home and landscaping to reduce your risk from a wildfire.

Be prepared for wildfires



Take steps to be ready for a wildfire and prepare your home and landscaping to reduce your risk from a wildfire.

Know your community's evacuation plans.

- Find several ways to leave your area.
- Drive the evacuation routes and find shelter locations.
- Have a plan for pets and livestock.

Gather emergency supplies, including respirators.

- Gather emergency supplies, including NIOSH Approved respirators. A respirator filters out smoke or ash before you can breathe it in.
- Remember the needs of children; individuals with medical conditions like asthma, Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD), diabetes, or heart disease; and those who are pregnant.

Can children wear respirators?

Children ages 2 years and older can wear respirators and masks. However, NIOSH Approved respirators do not come in suitable sizes for very young children. Choose a comfortable respirator or mask that your child can wear properly. If a

respirator or mask fits poorly or is uncomfortable, a child might take it off or wear it incorrectly (for example, pulling it down from their nose). This reduces the intended benefits.

- Choose a size that fits over the child's nose and under the chin but does not impair vision.
- Follow the user instructions for the respirator or mask. These instructions may show how to make sure it fits properly.

  NIOSH Approved respirators and international respirators may be available in smaller sizes that fit children. However, manufacturers typically design them to be used by adults in workplaces. They may not have been tested for broad use in children.



Download Infographic PDF: English | Español

Plan to keep wildfire smoke outside.

- Choose a room you can close off from outside air.
- Set up a portable air cleaner or a filter to keep the air in this room cleaner even when it's smoky outdoors or in the rest of your home.

Schools and commercial buildings

School and commercial building administrators should make a plan to keep wildfire smoke out of the building. Learn more: Wildfires and Indoor Air Quality in Schools and Commercial Buildings | US EPA

Keep track of fires near you.

- Listen to the Emergency Alert System (EAS) and National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) Weather Radio for emergency alerts.
- Monitor fires in your area using mapping tools. AirNow's Fire and Smoke Map has a map of fires throughout North America. NOAA's Fire weather outlook page maps fire watches and warnings.

Resources

- Natural Disasters and Severe Weather
- Be Smoke Ready (airnow.gov)
- Wildfires | Ready.gov
- NFPA - Firewise USA®
- Fire Weather
- Fire and Smoke Map (airnow.gov)
- HeatRisk | Tracking | NCEH | CDC

ON THIS PAGE

Be prepared for wildfires

Resources

RELATED PAGES

Wildfires and Wildfire Smoke

After a Wildfire

About Wildfires

Wildfire Smoke

Wildfires and Wildfire Smoke